

GAME THEORY

Study Guide



9 . 10 . 11
OCTOBER

Introduction

The Game Theory category challenges delegates to showcase creativity, resourcefulness, and adaptability through practical, high-pressure tasks. Every decision demand clarity and innovation, proving that resilience and smart planning can transform limited means into impactful outcomes.

Delegate Cap:

Round 1: 2-3

Round 2: 2-3

Round 3: 2-3

Round 1: The Economic Gauntlet — Rapid Inference

Delegate Cap: 2 per team

Estimated Time: 45–60 minutes

Working in pairs, one delegate receives an economic term or concept, such as unemployment or economic bubble, and must draw it on a whiteboard without speaking or using letters or numbers.

Their teammate must guess the concept against the clock. Correct guesses earn points.

This is not an elimination round. All teams qualify, but the top 3 teams receive an advantage in Round 2.

Scoring:

- Correct Guess: +5
- First 30 Seconds Bonus: +2
- Rule Violation: -2

Round 2: Nash's Gambit — The Oligopoly Matrix

Delegate Cap: 2–3 per team

Estimated Time: 60–75 minutes

Teams act as rival corporations competing for market share. Across multiple phases, teams independently choose whether to cooperate and maintain market stability or undercut competitors to gain short-term profits.

A lobbying session will take place midway through the round, allowing teams to negotiate and form secret agreements. However, teams must account for the possibility of a last-minute betrayal. Strategic thinking, risk management, bluffing and understanding of incentives are key.

This is the elimination round. The two teams at the bottom of the table are eliminated.

Judging Criteria:

- Total Profit Earned /80%
- Negotiation & Diplomacy /20%

Round 3: Crisis Turnaround & Venture Pitch — Final Round

Delegate Cap: 2–3 per team

Estimated Time: 90–120 minutes

Teams act as emergency consultants for businesses facing economic crises.

Using a limited amount of in-game currency, teams participate in an auction to acquire physical raw materials. Teams must balance their spending carefully: overspending on one resource may leave them unable to acquire others, while spreading their bids too thin may prevent them from completing their product.

After the auction, teams must:

- Create a functional product or prototype using their resources
- Prepare a concise PowerPoint presentation
- Deliver a 1–2 minute pitch covering their operational strategy, cost breakdown and financial roadmap

Cross-questions from delegates are permitted.

Judging Criteria:

- Creativity & Innovation /25%
- Prototype Functionality /20%
- Resource & Budget Management /15%
- Business Feasibility /15%
- Financial Roadmap /10%
- Presentation & Delivery /10%
- Cross-Question Responses /5%